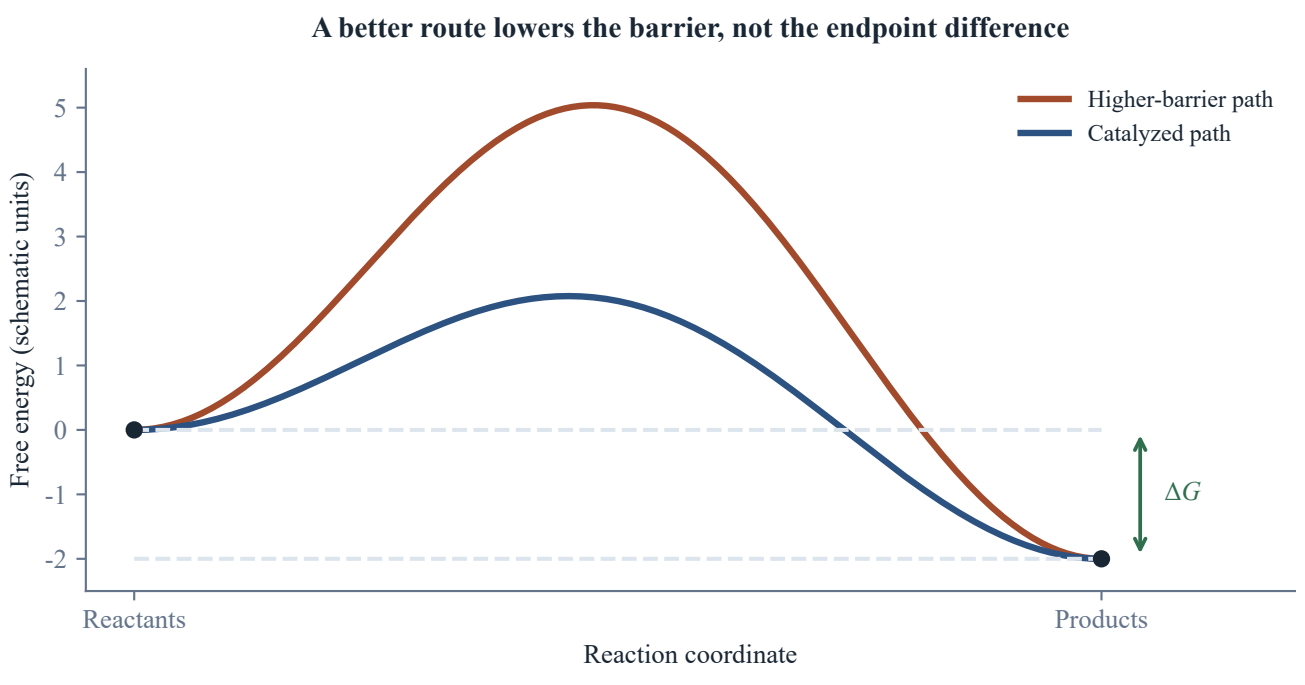

A better route lowers the barrier, not the endpoint difference
Higher-barrier path
Catalyzed path
Free energy (schematic units)
5
4
3
2
1
0
-1
-2
ΔG
Reactants
Products
Reaction coordinate